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Office Hours: Anytime you would like to meet, email me to set up a Zoom or in-person visit

Course Description

Organizational behavior addresses the human side of organizations—what people need and desire at work, how they use their time, talent, and energy for collective ends, and how they can work together effectively for a greater good. **Leadership** guides and influences others to engage in these collective endeavors.

BUAD 304 therefore has a dual focus on helping you: 1) learn evidence-based knowledge from the field of organizational behavior to identify and apply best organizational practices for leading teams and organizations, and 2) develop the interpersonal skills required to lead diverse groups and organizations effectively.

Learning Objectives

After successfully completing BUAD 304, you will be able to:

- Utilize organizational behavior theories, frameworks, principles, and tactics to prevent OB problems from emerging and, when problems are identified, intervene to fix them.
- Evaluate the benefits and challenges of alternatives to achieve high performance at the individual, team and organizational levels.
- Assess the effectiveness of a variety of leadership behaviors depending on the context.
- Create a plan to improve your own personal leadership skills and to manage your career.

The relationship between the course learning goals and the Marshall School of Business' undergraduate business program learning goals is described in Appendix A.

Open Expression and Respect for All

An important goal of the educational experience at USC Marshall is to be exposed to and discuss diverse, thought-provoking, and sometimes controversial ideas that challenge one's beliefs. In this course we will support the values articulated in the USC Marshall "Open Expression Statement" (<https://www.marshall.usc.edu/open-expression-statement>).

Required Materials

You need the following required resources for this course.

- (1) Textbook & Connect/LearnSmart You will need the ONLINE version of *Organizational Behavior: A Practical, Problem-Solving Approach* 3rd edition by Angelo Kinicki, 2020. McGraw Hill.

USC has a Digital Course Materials Program (DCMP), which provides access to many required textbooks, case studies and other resources for one flat fee. Our course materials have been submitted to the program coordinator and students have been sent notification about how to access the materials. Please check your usc.edu email for instructions on how to access the materials. More general information regarding the program can be found [here](#).

I strongly recommend that you access the textbook through the DCMP, as the price for the e-book and Connect will be a significant discount relative to purchasing the book independently from the Course Materials Program.

To purchase the required ONLINE version of our textbook independently via Brightspace, *Organizational Behavior: A Practical, Problem-Solving Approach*, 3rd edition by Angelo Kinicki (2020) follow these instructions to register directly with McGraw Hill.

1. Sign into our course Brightspace site (brightspace.usc.edu)
2. Go to our BUAD 304 Organizational Behavior and Leadership class page.
3. Click on one of your assignments in Brightspace, and you will jump over to the McGraw Hill website to purchase the textbook.
4. Please review the video at the link for additional information:
<https://www.mheducation.com/highered/support/support-at-every-step/connect/first-day-of-class/ia-d2l-ltia>

- (2) ARES Course Reader: The course reader is accessible for free on the USC Libraries ARES system online. Go to <https://reserves.usc.edu/ares/> and search for BUAD 304 for Fall 2026. Instructions for how to download the articles will be posted on Brightspace.

- (3) Case Reader: BUAD 304 Fall 2026 Organizational Behavior & Leadership Coursepack should also be accessed via the DCMP in the email sent to you. If you choose to opt out of DCMP, you will need to coordinate with me to buy the case-study coursepack separately. I strongly encourage you to opt in to DCMP, as buying the case-study coursepack independently is costly compared to the DCMP arrangement.

Additional Readings, Resources and Assessments

1. Videos are available on the USC Marshall Critical Thinking Initiative website to help you better understand how to do case analysis and use the Marshall USC-CT framework. You will want to watch these before completing the first case analysis memo.
<https://vimeo.com/388331882>
2. Personal assessments are listed in the class schedule with how to access them via a website or McGraw-Hill Connect.
3. Any additional readings and/or assessments will be posted on Brightspace.

Brightspace

Brightspace is the primary channel of communication for this course. All course information is available through your Brightspace account, so take note of announcements and other email messages you receive. Assignment and exam scores are posted here as well. To access Brightspace from your web browser, enter <https://brightspace.usc.edu> and use your USC username and password to log in.

Grading

Exams	50%
Midterm	25
Final	25
Team Project	25%
<i>Proposal & Paper</i>	20
<i>Presentation</i>	5
Individual Assignments	10%
<i>Case Analyses (5 cases)</i>	5
<i>Personal Reflection Paper</i>	5
Participation	15%
<i>Active Class Participation & Team Engagement</i>	13
<i>Research studies</i>	2
Total	100%

Final grade: Your final grade for this course will reflect the weighted sum of your assignment grades and will adhere to the grading policy approved by Marshall. Three items are considered when assigning final grades:

1. Your average weighted score as a percentage of the available points for all assignments (the points you receive divided by the number of points possible).
2. The overall average percentage score within the class.
3. Your ranking among all students in the class.

Review of Grades: Feedback and reflection are essential to learning. I am available to discuss how you are performing on assignments and class participation to help you improve and/or correct mistakes. This should occur BEFORE your final grade is posted. I invite you to contact me within a week when an assignment is returned to discuss it, so I can clarify my comments, which I assume you have read and reflected on your own first. If exams or assignments are graded by a Teaching Assistant, you will meet with the TA first since s/he will be in the best position to provide useful feedback. I will then meet with you if you have any additional questions or concerns.

Statement on Use of AI Tools: Creating, analyzing, and critical thinking skills are key learning outcomes of this course. Developing strong competencies in these areas will prepare you for a competitive workplace. All assignments should be prepared by you working alone or in groups if you have a team assignment. Another person or entity should not complete any substantive portion of the assignment. Application of AI-generated tools is prohibited and will be identified as plagiarism and reported to the Office of Academic Integrity.

Course Requirements: Exams

The midterm and final exams are in the same format, with 25 multiple-choice questions and 3-4 short concept-application essay questions. The midterm covers material from the first half of the course; the final covers material from the second half of the course. Refer to the exam study guide posted on Brightspace for information on the topics covered and a sample question. Make-up exams are not permitted. The midterm exam takes place in Week 6; the final exam occurs on the date and time assigned on the University final examination schedule. If you have another final exam scheduled for the exact same time as the final exam for this course, you must let me know about the conflict at least 2 weeks prior to the final exam.

Course Requirements: Team Project

You will work together with 4 or 5 classmates as an intact project team throughout the semester to prepare for and complete the Team Project. Your team will demonstrate that you understand the major challenges and key success factors to perform effectively as a member of a functioning team and a leader in business and society today. The aims of the team project include: (1) enriching your understanding of organizations and leadership; (2) providing you with an opportunity to apply what you have learned in the course; (3) assessing your ability to define and analyze an organization and derive insightful conclusions; and (4) helping you develop critical interpersonal and teamwork skills.

Your team will do a fieldwork project with a local establishment such as a student club, a campus work unit, or a community organization. Your team will investigate and analyze selected aspects of this organization related to relevant course concepts such as the organization's culture, the structure and functioning of groups within the organization, its reward systems, or its relation to its local or national environment. You will make recommendations or identify best practices based on your study.

There are four “deliverables” for this team.

- 1) Project proposal: 1-page memo
- 2) Project paper: An 8–10-page analytical paper
- 3) In-class presentation: A 15-minute presentation, 5 minutes for Q&A
- 4) Self & peer evaluation feedback: Online assessment explained in class

Feedback helps you learn and improve your performance as well as the quality of your output as a team. As part of the team project, you will practice and develop skills in providing and receiving effective feedback through in-class exercises and a more formal peer evaluation survey that will be posted on Brightspace.

The final grade for this project is based on the four components outlined above. Further instructions and grading rubrics are posted on Brightspace.

Grades for individual student contributions to team projects are **assigned by your professor**, based on observations of the team's working dynamics, assessment of the team project quality, and thoughtful consideration of the information provided through your peer evaluations.

Course Requirements: Individual Assignments

Case Analysis: To prepare to engage in classroom case discussions, you will need to complete a 1-page analysis of the assigned case before attending class. This will enable you to apply the concepts and theories from the assigned readings to a real-world situation. This goes beyond simply reading the case. You will identify the problem (s) in the case and apply the relevant concepts/theories to explain their underlying causes. Additional instructions and a grading rubric are posted on Brightspace.

Personal Reflection Paper: You will write a paper that describes what you have learned about yourself and your capability as a leader from your experiences and learning in the course. This involves thoughtful reflection and insightful connection between your course experience and the learning or insights you have gained about yourself. Narrative accounts that convey an understanding of your experience supported by course material and your personal assessment results are helpful. Instructions and a grading rubric are posted on Brightspace.

Course Requirements: Participation

Class Participation and Team Engagement: This part of your grade is based on consistent and effective contributions to class discussions/activities and active engagement with your project team. You are expected to attend every class session having read, thought about, and prepared any assigned material. You should also be ready to share your ideas and actively listen to and interpret the ideas presented by others. Also, missing more than two lectures or leaving early for more than two lectures will affect your performance in the course unless you communicate in advance with the professor. Missing three or more classes without a reasonable conversation with the professor will result in the loss of at least a full letter grade.

Comments that are vague, repetitive, unrelated to the discussion, or disrespectful of others will be evaluated negatively. Quality comments possess one or more of the following attributes:

- Offer a relevant concept or personal experience.
- Provide careful analysis by applying concepts from readings and lectures.
- Move the discussion forward by building on previous contributions with new insights.
- Ask thoughtful and challenging questions.

Openness, respect, and active engagement are essential to our classroom learning. Class sessions are psychologically safe where we can all learn together and benefit from each other's perspectives and experiences. Because there is rarely one right answer in organizational behavior and leadership, discussions are richer if you share your unique perspective.

Research Studies: One part of your participation grade is based on your involvement in research activities. The purpose of this research requirement is to expose you to how the scientific process

works and to provide you with an opportunity to contribute to Marshall School research. The research participation requirement is a comprehensive experience that includes research lab participation and field study contributions as integrated components. The steps for you to participate in the Research Studies are listed in Brightspace.

Weekly Schedule (listed in Brightspace)

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

USC Marshall Critical Thinking Initiative

The USC Marshall Critical Thinking Initiative is a school-wide effort to improve your critical thinking skills in order to be more successful problem solvers in class and ultimately in the workplace. This means that you will engage in a variety of learning activities in your courses which are aimed at developing and applying your critical thinking skills in a disciplined manner so that you can outperform others to get your desired job and to further excel in your career. Your ability to think critically is an important part of the evaluation/grading process in this course. The centerpiece of Marshall's critical thinking knowledge is a website that contains instructional materials and videos. We utilize these resources to prepare you to do the case analysis assignments as noted in Course Materials. Website: <https://vimeo.com/388331882>

Add/Drop Process

Most Marshall classes are open enrollment (R-clearance) through the Add deadline. If there is an open seat, you can add the class using Web Registration. If the class is full, you will need to continue checking Web Registration or the *Schedule of Classes* (classes.usc.edu) to see if a space becomes available. Students who do not attend the first two class sessions (for classes that meet twice per week) or the first class meeting (for classes that meet once per week) may be dropped from the course. Therefore, let me know if you have any conflicts in Week 1 like visa or health issues so you aren't dropped. There are no formal wait lists for Marshall undergraduate courses, and professors cannot add students or increase the course capacity. If all sections of the course are full, you can add your name to an interest list by contacting the Office of Undergraduate Advising & Student Affairs; if new seats or sections are added, students on the interest list will be notified.

Retention of Graded Coursework

Final exams and all other graded work, which affects the course grade, will be retained for one year after the end of the course *if* the graded work has not been returned to the student (i.e., if we returned a graded paper to you, it is your responsibility to file it, not ours). We recommend that you keep returned work in a folder or other safe place in the event you need to reference it.

Statement on Technology Use

It is far more important to participate than to take detailed notes. Course PPT slides will be posted on Brightspace. After each class session, you may want to take some time to reflect on the learning experience and type up whatever notes seem useful. You should turn off your mobile phone and kept off throughout the class session unless you are using it to access the class session. Participation/Contribution points will be deducted for students misusing technology during class. We invite you to "Be Here, Be Present!" to create an engaging learning community.

Religious/Cultural Observance

Persons who have religious or cultural observances that coincide with class should let me know by email as soon as possible so we can make accommodations for any missed work or participation. I strongly encourage you to honor your cultural and religious holidays! However, if I do not hear from you before the holiday, I will assume that you plan to attend all class meetings.

Use of Recordings

Pursuant to the USC Student Handbook (www.usc.edu/scampus, Part B, 11.12), students may not record a university class without the express permission of the instructor and announcement to the class. In addition, students may not distribute or use notes or recordings based on University classes or lectures without the express permission of the instructor for purposes other than personal or class-related group study by individuals registered for the class. This restriction on unauthorized use applies to all information that is distributed or displayed for use in relationship to the class.

Emergency Preparedness/Course Continuity

In case of a declared emergency if travel to campus is not feasible, the USC Emergency Information web site (<https://www.usc.edu/emergency/>) will provide safety and other information, including electronic means by which instructors will conduct class using a combination of USC's Brightspace learning management system (TBD), teleconferencing, and other technologies.

Incomplete Grades

A mark of IN (incomplete) may be assigned when work is not completed because of a documented illness or other "emergency" that occurs after the 12th week of the semester (or the twelfth week equivalent for any course that is scheduled for less than 15 weeks).

An "emergency" is defined as a serious documented illness, or an unforeseen situation that is beyond the student's control, that prevents a student from completing the semester. Prior to the 12th week, the student still has the option of dropping the class. Arrangements for completing an IN must be initiated by the student and agreed to by the instructor prior to the final examination. If an Incomplete is assigned as the student's grade, the instructor is required to fill out an "**Assignment of an Incomplete (IN) and Requirements for Completion**" form which specifies to the student and to the department the work remaining to be done, the procedures for its completion, the grade in the course to date, and the weight to be assigned to work remaining to be done when the final grade is computed. Both the instructor and student must sign the form with a copy of the form filed in the department. Class work to complete the course must be completed within one calendar year from the date the IN was assigned. The IN mark will be converted to an F grade should the course not be completed within the time allowed.

Statement on Academic Conduct and Support Systems

Academic Integrity:

The University of Southern California is foremost a learning community committed to fostering successful scholars and researchers dedicated to the pursuit of knowledge and the transmission of

ideas. Academic misconduct is contrary to this fundamental mission and includes any act of dishonesty in the submission of academic work (either in draft or final form), as well as cheating, plagiarism, fabrication (e.g., falsifying data), knowingly assisting others in acts of academic dishonesty, and any act that gains or is intended to gain an unfair academic advantage. Students are expected to uphold the highest standards of academic integrity in all coursework.

This course follows the expectations for academic integrity as stated in the USC Student Handbook. All students are expected to submit assignments that are original work and prepared specifically for the course/section in this academic term. Students may not submit work written by others or “recycle” work prepared for other courses without obtaining written permission from the instructor(s). Students suspected of academic misconduct will be reported to the Office of Academic Integrity.

Other violations of academic misconduct include, but are not limited to, cheating, plagiarism, fabrication (e.g., falsifying data), knowingly assisting others in acts of academic dishonesty, and any act that gains or is intended to gain an unfair academic advantage.

Academic dishonesty has a far-reaching impact and is considered a serious offense against the university. Violations will result in a grade penalty, such as a failing grade on the assignment or in the course, and disciplinary action from the university, such as suspension or expulsion.

For more information about academic integrity see the Student Handbook, the Office of Academic Integrity’s website, and university policies on Research and Scholarship Misconduct.

Please ask your instructor if you are unsure what constitutes unauthorized assistance on an exam or assignment or what information requires citation and/or attribution.

University Academic and Support Systems:

Students and Disability Accommodations: USC welcomes students with disabilities into all of the University’s educational programs. The Office of Student Accessibility Services (OSAS) is responsible for the determination of appropriate accommodations for students who encounter disability-related barriers. Once a student has completed the OSAS process (registration, initial appointment, and submitted documentation) and accommodations are determined to be reasonable and appropriate, a Letter of Accommodation (LOA) will be available to generate for each course. The LOA must be given to each course instructor by the student and followed up with a discussion. This should be done as early in the semester as possible as accommodations are not retroactive. More information can be found at osas.usc.edu. You may contact OSAS at (213) 740-0776 or via email at osasfrontdesk@usc.edu.

Student Financial Aid and Satisfactory Academic Progress: To be eligible for certain kinds of financial aid, students are required to maintain Satisfactory Academic Progress (SAP) toward their degree objectives. Visit the Financial Aid Office webpage for undergraduate- and graduate-level SAP eligibility requirements and the appeals process.

Support Systems: *Counseling and Mental Health* - (213) 740-9355 – 24/7 on call

Free and confidential mental health treatment for students, including short-term psychotherapy, group counseling, stress fitness workshops, and crisis intervention. 988 Suicide and Crisis Lifeline - 988 for both calls and text messages – 24/7 on call

The 988 Suicide and Crisis Lifeline (formerly known as the National Suicide Prevention Lifeline) provides free and confidential emotional support to people in suicidal crisis or emotional distress 24 hours a day, 7 days a week, across the United States. The Lifeline consists of a national network of over 200 local crisis centers, combining custom local care and resources with national standards and best practices. The new, shorter phone number makes it easier for people to remember and access mental health crisis services (though the previous 1 (800) 273-8255 number will continue to function indefinitely) and represents a continued commitment to those in crisis.

CARE-SC: Confidential Advocacy, Resources, and Education Support Center - (213) 740-9355(WELL) – 24/7/365 on call.

Confidential advocates, prevention educators, and professional counseling teams work to promote a universal culture of consent, as well as prevent and respond to sexual assault, intimate partner violence, stalking, or other relationship harm. Services available to all USC students at no cost.

Office of Civil Rights Compliance - (213) 740-5086

Information about how to get help or help someone affected by harassment, discrimination, retaliation on the basis of a protected characteristic, rights of protected classes, reporting options, and additional resources for students, faculty, staff, visitors, and applicants.

USC Report & Response - (213) 740-2500

The USC Report & Response website is the university's central reporting portal for concerns arising in the academic space or workplace. All concerns will be assessed and referred to the appropriate university office for resolution. Any questions about USC Report & Response or reporting, in general, can be referred to the Office of Professionalism and Ethics at ope@usc.edu.

USC Campus Support and Intervention - (213) 740-0411

Focuses on student success by assisting students in navigating and resolving complex issues through problem solving, presenting options, and connecting to resources.

USC Emergency Information

Latest updates regarding safety, including ways in which instruction will be continued if an officially declared emergency makes travel to campus infeasible.

USC Department of Public Safety

For 24 hour emergency assistance or to report a crime: UPC: (213) 740-4321, HSC: (323)-442-1000.

For 24 hour non-emergency assistance or information: UPC: (213) 740-6000, HSC: 323-442-1200.

Office of the Ombuds - (213) 821-9556 (UPC) / (323-442-0382 (HSC)

A safe and confidential place to share your USC-related issues with a University Ombuds who will work with you to explore options or paths to manage your concern.

Occupational Therapy Faculty Practice - (323) 442-2850 or otfp@med.usc.edu

Confidential Lifestyle Redesign services for USC students to support health promoting habits and routines that enhance quality of life and academic performance.

Appendix A



Undergraduate Program Learning Goals and Objectives **BUAD 304 Coverage of Learning Goals**

Learning goal 1: Our graduates will demonstrate critical thinking skills so as to become future-oriented problem solvers, innovators and decision makers in diverse and rapidly changing business environments. ● Students will demonstrate the ability to anticipate, identify and solve business problems. They will be able to identify and assess central problems, identify and evaluate potential solutions, and translate a chosen solution to an implementation plan that considers future contingencies ● Students will demonstrate the ability to be accurate, clear, expansive (thorough, detailed) and fair-minded in their thinking ● Students will critically analyze concepts, theories and processes by stating them in their own words, understanding key components, identifying assumptions, indicating how they are similar to and different from others and translating them to the real world ● Students will be effective at gathering, storing, and using qualitative and quantitative data and at using analytical tools and frameworks to understand and solve business problems ● Students will understand the concepts of critical thinking, entrepreneurial thinking and creative thinking as drivers of innovative ideas	<u>High</u>
Learning Goal 2: Our graduates will develop people and leadership skills to promote their effectiveness as business managers and leaders in the 21st century's evolving work and organizational structures. ● Students will recognize, understand and analyze the roles, responsibilities and behaviors of effective managers and leaders in diverse business contexts e.g., functionally diverse, culturally diverse, geographically diverse, etc. ● Students will understand factors that contribute to effective teamwork including how to elicit, manage and leverage diverse perspectives and competencies. ● Students will recognize, understand, and analyze the motivations and behaviors of stakeholders inside and outside organizations (e.g., teams, departments, consumers, investors, auditors)	<u>High</u>
Learning Goal 3: Our graduates will be effective communicators to facilitate information flow in organizational, social, and intercultural contexts. ● Students will identify and assess diverse personal and organizational communication goals and audience information needs ● Students will demonstrate an ability to gather and disseminate information and communicate it clearly, logically, and persuasively in professional contexts ● Students will understand individual and group communications patterns and dynamics in organizations and other professional contexts	<u>Medium</u>

Learning goal 4: Our graduates will demonstrate ethical reasoning skills, understand social, civic, and professional responsibilities <i>and aspire to add value to society.</i> ● Students will recognize ethical challenges in business situations and assess appropriate courses of action ● Students will understand professional codes of conduct	<u>High</u>
Learning goal 5: Our graduates will develop a global business perspective. They will understand how local, regional, and international markets, and economic, social and cultural issues impact business decisions <i>so as to anticipate new opportunities in any marketplace.</i> ● Students will understand that stakeholders, stakeholder interests, business environments (legal, regulatory, competitor) and business practices vary across regions of the world Students will understand how local, regional and global markets interact and are impacted by economic, social and cultural factors.	<u>Medium</u>
Learning goal 6: Our graduates will understand types of markets and key business areas and their interaction <i>to effectively manage different types of enterprises.</i> ● Students will demonstrate foundational knowledge of core business disciplines, including business analytics and business economics ● Students will understand the interrelationships between functional areas of business so as to develop a general perspective on business management ● Students will apply theories, models, and frameworks to analyze relevant markets (e.g. product, capital, commodity, factor and labor markets) ● Students will be able to use technologies (e.g., spreadsheets, databases, software) relevant to contemporary business practices	<u>Low</u>